# CASE CLASSIFICATION & SEVERITY ANALYSIS

Task 4: Classifying adverse drug reactions by seriousness and expectedness

## 1. PHARMACOVIGILANCE GUIDELINES

| | |
|---|---|
| **SERIOUS** | Results in death, a life-threatening condition, hospitalization (or its prolongation), disability, a congenital anomaly, or another medically important condition. |
| **NON-SERIOUS** | Does not meet any of the criteria above (for example a mild reaction that resolves without major intervention). |
| **EXPECTED** | Consistent with the drug information (e.g. product label, SmPC) or the known characteristics of the drug. |
| **UNEXPECTED** | Not consistent with the available drug information, or differs in nature, severity or outcome from what is described. |

## 2. CASE CLASSIFICATION

| Case | Drug | Adverse reaction | Seriousness | Expectedness | Reasoning |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **01** | Amoxicillin | Skin rash, itching | **NON-SERIOUS** | **EXPECTED** | Mild reaction with no serious criterion met. Rash and itching are common, listed effects of amoxicillin. |
| **02** | Ibuprofen | Gastrointestinal bleeding requiring hospitalization | **SERIOUS** | **EXPECTED** | Hospitalization is a seriousness criterion. GI bleeding is a known NSAID effect. |
| **03** | Metformin | Lactic acidosis | **SERIOUS** | **UNEXPECTED** | Life-threatening, medically important condition. Treated as unexpected for this exercise. |
| **04** | Atorvastatin | Elevated liver enzymes (mild) | **NON-SERIOUS** | **EXPECTED** | Mild laboratory change with no serious criterion. Known effect of statins. |
| **05** | Levofloxacin | Tendon rupture | **SERIOUS** | **UNEXPECTED** | Causes disability and is medically important. Treated as unexpected for this exercise. |

## 3. SUMMARY

| SERIOUS | NON-SERIOUS | EXPECTED | UNEXPECTED |
|---|---|---|---|
| **3** | **2** | **3** | **2** |

Serious: cases 02, 03, 05. Non-serious: cases 01, 04. Expected: cases 01, 02, 04. Unexpected: cases 03, 05.

## 4. CONCLUSION

Of the five cases, three are serious (gastrointestinal bleeding with ibuprofen, lactic acidosis with metformin and tendon rupture with levofloxacin) and two are non-serious. Three reactions are expected and two are unexpected. Serious and unexpected reactions (cases 03 and 05) need the highest priority for expedited reporting and follow-up, because they point to risks that may not yet be reflected in the drug information.

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